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BIOTECH & HEALTH



Linda Yaccarino joins
health tech platform
eMed as CEO after
leaving X

Linda Yaccarino's next role after [departing](#) X as CEO will be another chief executive role at [eMed Population Health](#), an AI startup building a tech platform for patients using GLP-1s.

Yaccarino was a longtime advertising executive at NBCUniversal but left to join X as CEO for two years, where she managed to have a [positive impact](#) on the social network's troubled ad revenue model, despite her and Elon Musk's shared approach to minimizing content moderation.

Though Yaccarino does not have experience in health tech, eMed said in a [press release](#) that they sought her out for her [undeniable ability to negotiate new partnerships](#) — it certainly also helps that her tenure at X made her well-known in the tech world, drawing more eyes toward the startup.

eMed [previously](#) produced a tech platform that was designed to be used with at-home COVID-19 rapid antigen tests, guiding users through the process of administering these tests properly. Now eMed is focused on GLP-1s, the class of drugs like Ozempic, which can be used for both weight management and treatment of type 2 diabetes.

"To be a leader in today's healthcare marketplace, companies need to have a fearless tenacity that allows them to not only grow, but to also be brave enough to step forward and redefine an entire industry," Yaccarino [said](#) in a press release. "We are

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very well-positioned to be that tenacious leader, striving toward our ultimate goal of improving global healthcare outcomes through our groundbreaking services and platforms.”

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 **Amanda Silberling**
Senior Writer | [X](#) [🐼](#) [in](#)

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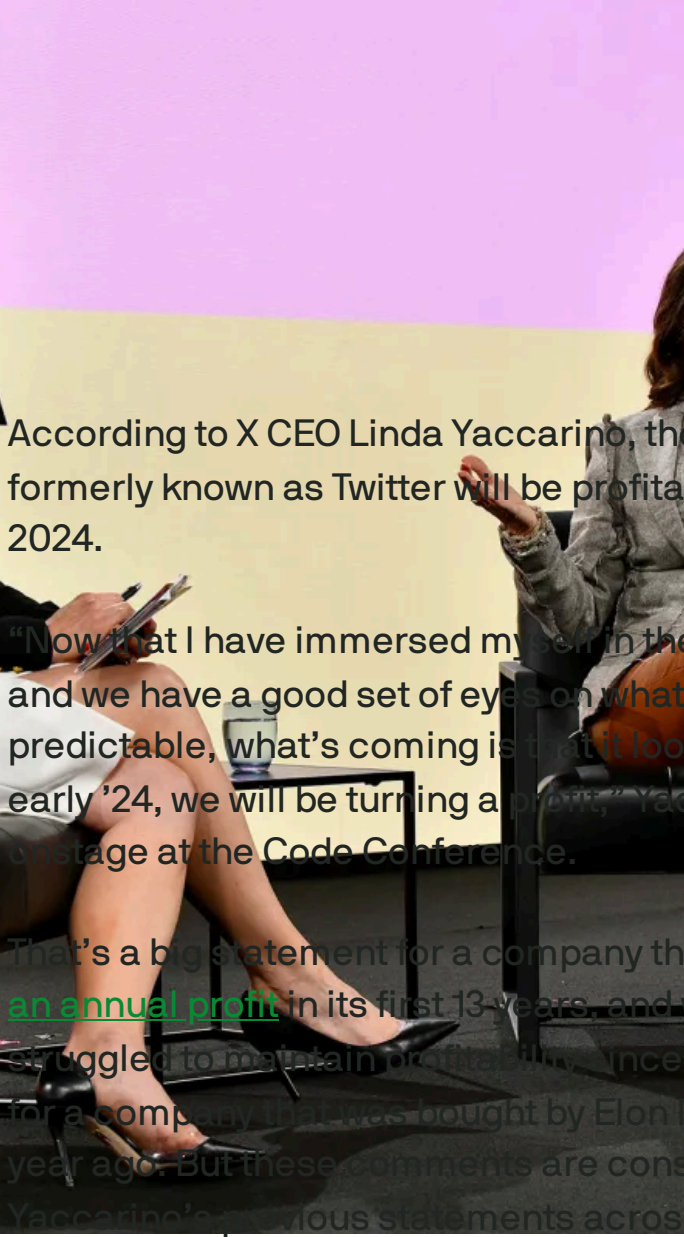
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X will be profitable in 2024, CEO claims in tense interview



According to X CEO Linda Yaccarino, the company formerly known as Twitter will be profitable by early 2024.

“Now that I have immersed myself in the business, and we have a good set of eyes on what is predictable, what’s coming is that it looks like in early ’24, we will be turning a profit,” Yaccarino said onstage at the Code Conference.

That’s a big statement for a company that didn’t turn an annual profit in its first 13 years, and which has struggled to maintain profitability since — let alone for a company that was bought by Elon Musk only a year ago. But these comments are consistent with Yaccarino’s previous statements across the few

months since she became CEO. In August, she said on CNBC that X was “pretty close to breakeven” in terms of operational run rate. In July, she stated in a leaked memo that X usage was at an all-time high.

Yaccarino said onstage today that, “90% of the top 100 advertisers have returned to the platform in the last 12 weeks alone.”

X also reduced its spending by cutting the size of its staff from 8,000 to about 1,500; further, laid-off employees still have not been paid severance. X is also facing multiple lawsuits over not paying rent for office space in several countries.

Yaccarino added that the time users spend on X has gone up since June. But the interviewer, CNBC’s Julia Boorstin, pushed back on such claims about user engagement, pointing to data from app

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analytics firm Apptopia. Though Boorstin didn't cite the specific statistics, Apptopia has recently [reported](#) that X downloads are down 30% in the two months after its rebrand from Twitter. Apptopia also reported decreased web traffic to X, and lower user numbers since before Twitter went public.

Around the time that Boorstin asked about daily active users, the air between the two turned somewhat hostile. Yaccarino came onstage already on the defensive, as the Code Conference added an interview with former Twitter trust and safety head Yoel Roth to the day's events at the last minute. Though Musk was fond of Roth at the beginning of his tenure at Twitter, Roth ended up leaving the company and was subject to serious threats and harassment, which Musk played no small part in.



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When asked about what advice he would give to Yaccarino, Roth had more to say about her own personal safety than her management of X. He said he was taken aback by a recent profile of Yaccarino,

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In which she opened up about the online attacks she’s weathered in her new role.

“Nobody should have to experience that. Not a CEO, not a journalist, not me. Not anybody.... Look what your boss did to me,” he said, referencing Musk’s role in his harassment, which became so extreme that he had to go into [hiding](#).

“It happened to me. It happened after he sang my praises publicly. It happened after I didn’t attack him. I didn’t attack the company. I quietly left,” Roth said, then spoke directly to Yaccarino. “For those that you love, you should be worried. I wish I had been more worried.”

[Twitter \(now X\) CEO Linda Yaccarino claims usage at ‘all time high’ in memo to staff](#)

Topics: [linda yaccarino](#) [Social](#) [Twitter](#) [X](#)



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Senior Writer |

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Linda Yaccarino leaves NBCUniversal, adding fuel to the Twitter CEO fire

Ingrid Lunden, Amanda Silberling

6:36 AM PDT · May 12, 2023

Linda Yaccarino, the woman [hotly tipped as the next CEO of Twitter](#), has not made any statements

confirming or denying the rumors. But she is definitely open to work: today, NBCUniversal, where she had been the chairman of its advertising and partnerships group, announced that she is leaving the company, effective immediately.

“It has been an absolute honor to be part of Comcast NBCUniversal and lead the most incredible team,” she said in a statement. “We’ve transformed our company and the entire industry—and I am so proud of what we’ve accomplished together, and grateful to my colleagues and mentors, especially Brian Roberts, Mike Cavanagh and the entire NBCU leadership team.”

Mark Marshall, currently president of ad sales and client partnerships, is taking over the role on an interim basis.

IMAGE CREDITS:

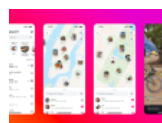
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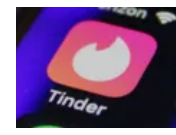
Aisha Malik - 17 hours ago

The speculation over who would take over the CEO role Twitter kicked off yesterday, when Elon Musk, Twitter’s owner and current CEO, [announced](#) (on Twitter) that he’d found someone to take over the job, noting that “she will be starting in [about] six weeks.”

NBCU’s announcement will be seen by many as an indirect confirmation of the reports that Yaccarino will be the executive in question. It may even mean that an official Twitter announcement might come as soon as today.

(The fact that Musk played by at least some semblance of rules here is interesting: Is that the new CEO’s influence at play already? NBCU was once a key media partner for Twitter in its heyday, so playing nice here and coordinating with their own media strategy might be a nod to that too.)

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Tinder explores a redesign, dating ‘modes,’ and college-specific features to boost engagement

Ivan Mehta - 18 hours ago

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Photo-sharing app Locket is banking on a new celebrity-focused feature to fuel its growth

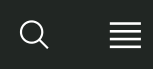
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Applying erratic policies to moderation, verification and other important aspects of Twitter's user environment and laying off an enormous proportion of its staff focused on all of those areas plus others critical to revenue generation (including its sales teams) the site has bled advertisers, and with that, revenues.

Now, the big question is whether it will be able to claw some of that back, and if so how it will do so without falling afoul of Musk, and Musk's accounting priorities.



Musk and Yaccarino already seem to have a bit of a rapport. Last month, Yaccarino interviewed Musk at an advertising conference in Miami, where she seemed complimentary of the business mogul.

“Elon has committed to being accessible to everyone for continual feedback,” she [said onstage](#). “He’s also opened up himself to also participate in the new transparency and safety rules he posted yesterday. Just remember, freedom of speech does not mean freedom of reach.”

She also pointed out to Elon that “the people in this room are [Twitter’s] path to profitability.” Since its inception, Twitter’s most effective way to make money has been [advertising](#), and Musk’s attempts to [monetize the blue check](#) have not been successful.

We don’t know whether the two of them were in negotiations at the time, but Yaccarino seemed motivated to sanitize the Twitter brand, encouraging audience members to voice their concerns to Musk in an Q&A.

Yaccarino could appear like a breath of fresh air compared to Musk, who is known to [post weed jokes](#) (and worse) late into the night. She knows the advertising business, and advertisers know her well, too. So, large brands would very likely be more comfortable advertising on a Twitter that she

operates, rather than Musk. But per her own Twitter follows list, she seems to interface with the same controversial media brands that Musk promotes and follows, like conservative satire outlet The Babylon Bee (once [suspended](#) from Twitter for its transphobic jokes) and Chaya Raichik, who runs the [anti-LGBTQ+](#) social media account Libs of TikTok. This doesn't necessarily mean Yaccarino endorses these views, but it's an interesting data point given the [impact](#) Musk's takeover has had on the [safety](#) of LGBTQ+ individuals on Twitter. And under Donald Trump's presidency, Yaccarino was [appointed](#) to the President's Council on Sports, Fitness and Nutrition.

"If freedom of speech, as he says, is the bedrock of this country, I'm not sure there's anyone in this room who could disagree with that," Yaccarino said when interviewing Musk. "Could I get a round of applause for that?"

Updated, 5/12/23, 10:15 AM ET with additional context.

https://techcrunch.com/2023/05/12/elon-musks-twitter-everything-you-need-to-know-from-layoffs-to-verification/?utm_source=internal&utm_medium=WPunit

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Europe Editor | X f in

Ingrid was a writer and editor for TechCrunch, from February 2012 through May 2025, based out of London....

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Want to pay less for your X ads? Just place them next to spam



X [says](#) it has “delivered a decade’s worth of innovation focused on creating an engaging and healthy environment” since Elon Musk’s acquisition. Sure!

Everyone knows that when you think about X, you immediately think of closing a tab the twenty fourth letter of the alphabet porn Ed Sheeran’s second studio album X, which peaked at #1 on the Billboard 200 brand safety. So, under advertising veteran and new Twitter X CEO Linda Yaccarino, the social platform is throwing a Hail Mary to appeal to advertisers, who have [largely fled X](#) since it was sold to Elon Musk.

X is expanding its partnership with [Integral Ad Science \(IAS\)](#), which it [began working with](#) in January to tell advertisers if their ad is placed around inappropriate content. Now, X is testing sensitivity settings, powered by machine learning, that let advertisers choose their thresholds for the kinds of content they want their ads to appear around — and according to a tweet from X owner Elon Musk, advertisers can buy these less desirable, “relaxed” sensitivity ad slots for less.

“I would recommend advertisers not be super concerned about content adjacency,” Musk [wrote](#). “Tesla and SpaceX are not and the ‘less desirable’ ad inventory is much cheaper!”

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Sensitivity settings

Reduce adjacency to varying levels of sensitive content on the "For you" Timeline according to your brand's sensitivity threshold. **Standard Sensitivity is selected by default.**

Content that is in violation of [X's Rules](#) is excluded regardless of the sensitivity level selected.

Relaxed (coming soon)

Show ads alongside some sensitive content to maximize reach

Avoidance example: targeted hate speech, explicit sexual content

Standard

Shows ads alongside a reduced range of content for brands with moderate sensitivity thresholds

Avoidance example: targeted hate speech, explicit sexual content, gratuitous gore, excessive profanity

Conservative

Shows ads alongside limited content for brands with strict sensitivity thresholds*

Avoidance example: targeted hate speech, sexual content, gratuitous gore, excessive profanity, obscenity, spam, drugs

IMAGE CREDITS: X

In the most conservative setting, brands can reduce adjacency to gore, excessive profanity and obscenity, targeted hate speech, sexual content, drugs and spam. However, X's AI moderation tools have proven deeply unskillful at detecting [spam](#), so it's a good thing that X is claiming to "reduce," rather than "eliminate" adjacency to such content. Soon, X will add its "relaxed" setting, which offers cheaper advertising opportunities while only filtering for targeted hate speech and explicit sexual content.

To be fair, it's basic economics. If you have more supply than demand, lower your prices... and also lower the quality of your product, I guess.

[How far have Twitter's advertising revenues fallen?](#)

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Twitter partners with DoubleVerify and IAS on brand safety initiative amid advertiser exits

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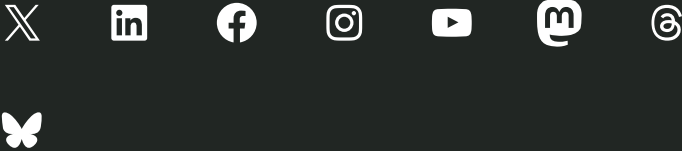
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